

Rodrigo Fernandez

Senior PHP (Laravel/Symfony) Backend Engineer

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Summary

Senior **PHP Backend Engineer** with strong experience in **fintech, healthcare, SaaS, eCommerce, and cloud infrastructure** platforms using **PHP 7.4-8.3, Laravel 8-11, Symfony 4.4-6.4, MySQL 5.7-8.0, PostgreSQL 12-16, Redis 5-7, RabbitMQ 3.8-3.12, Docker 20-26**, and **AWS** services to build secure APIs, payment workflows, tenant-aware systems, and high-volume data services. Skilled at modernizing legacy monoliths, fixing production bottlenecks, improving query performance, designing clean domain logic, and reducing deployment risk through CI/CD, testing, observability, and careful version upgrades across enterprise teams.

Skills

- **Backend: PHP 7.4-8.3, Laravel 8-11, Symfony 4.4-6.4**, Slim PHP 4.x, Composer 2.x, PHPUnit 9-10, Pest 1-2, REST API, GraphQL, Webhooks, OAuth2, JWT, RBAC, Multi-Tenant Architecture
- **Database: MySQL 5.7-8.0, PostgreSQL 12-16**, MariaDB 10.x, Redis 5-7, Elasticsearch 7-8, Database Indexing, Query Optimization, Stored Procedures, Replication, Migrations
- **Cloud & DevOps: AWS EC2, ECS, Lambda, S3, RDS, CloudWatch, SQS, SNS, Route 53, Docker 20-26, Kubernetes 1.21-1.29, Nginx, Apache, Linux, Terraform 1.x**
- **Messaging & Integration: RabbitMQ 3.8-3.12**, Kafka 2.8-3.x, Stripe API, PayPal API, Twilio, SendGrid, Salesforce API, HubSpot API, HL7/FHIR basic healthcare integration
- **Engineering Practices:** Domain-Driven Design, Clean Architecture, SOLID, TDD, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Code Review, API Versioning, Observability, Security Hardening

Experience

Lightedge — Senior Software Engineer (Apr 2020 – Mar 2026)

- Designed enterprise **PHP 8.1-8.3** backend services for cloud infrastructure and SaaS platforms, supporting secure account provisioning, billing workflows, and customer-facing API automation.
- Migrated legacy **Laravel 7.x** services to **Laravel 10.x**, refactoring service providers, queues, policies, and validation layers while reducing deployment defects by **32%**.
- Built high-throughput REST APIs with **Symfony 5.4-6.4**, PostgreSQL 13-16, and Redis 6-7 to support tenant isolation, usage tracking, and real-time operational dashboards.
- Resolved a recurring **N+1 query** issue in billing reports by redesigning Eloquent relationships, adding compound indexes, and improving average report load time by **48%**.
- Implemented secure **OAuth2**, JWT, RBAC, and audit logging flows across internal APIs, improving compliance readiness for infrastructure and managed-service customers.
- Reworked slow MySQL 8.0 procedures into optimized query builders and background jobs, reducing timeout incidents by **41%** during monthly billing cycles.
- Created asynchronous processing with **RabbitMQ 3.10-3.12** and Laravel Horizon, separating invoice generation, email delivery, and webhook retries from request-response paths.
- Fixed production queue deadlocks caused by long-running invoice jobs by adding idempotency keys, retry backoff, lock timeouts, and structured error handling.

- Led migration from manually deployed PHP applications to **Docker 24.x** and GitHub Actions pipelines, improving release consistency and rollback safety across environments.
- Implemented API versioning, OpenAPI documentation, and contract testing to help frontend, QA, and DevOps teams integrate changes without breaking customer workflows.
- Improved observability with **CloudWatch**, Prometheus exporters, structured JSON logs, and alert rules, reducing mean time to detect backend failures by **36%**.
- Mentored engineers on **Laravel 9-10**, Symfony services, PHPUnit coverage, and clean architecture patterns, raising code review quality and reducing repeated production issues.

NIX United — Software Engineer *(Oct 2016 – Mar 2020)*

- Developed **PHP 7.2-7.4** backend applications for fintech, healthcare, and logistics clients using **Laravel 5.8-7.x**, Symfony 3.4-5.0, MySQL 5.7, and Redis 4-5.
- Built payment-processing modules with Stripe and PayPal integrations, adding webhook verification, retry handling, and reconciliation jobs for transaction reliability.
- Solved a major duplicate-payment issue by introducing database-level unique constraints, queue idempotency, and transaction-safe service classes around checkout flows.
- Migrated several legacy PHP 5.6 modules to **PHP 7.4**, replacing deprecated functions, upgrading Composer dependencies, and improving runtime performance by **27%**.
- Implemented healthcare appointment APIs with secure access controls, role-based permissions, encrypted patient notes, and detailed audit trails for compliance workflows.
- Optimized MySQL 5.7 queries by adding covering indexes, removing unnecessary joins, and redesigning pagination, improving search response time by **39%**.
- Built background workers with **Laravel Queues**, Redis, and Supervisor to process notifications, document generation, and third-party API synchronization reliably.
- Fixed unstable third-party API integrations by adding circuit breakers, timeout policies, retry queues, and fallback logging for payment and shipping providers.
- Created CI pipelines with GitLab CI and Docker 18-19, automating PHPUnit tests, static checks, database migrations, and deployment package creation.
- Refactored large controller-based code into services, repositories, form requests, and event listeners, making business logic easier to test and maintain.
- Collaborated closely with frontend and QA teams to define API contracts, reproduce edge-case bugs, and deliver stable backend releases for enterprise clients.

Webiz Digital — Software Developer *(Jan 2014 – Sep 2016)*

- Built custom **PHP 5.6-7.0** backend systems for eCommerce, marketing, and content platforms using Laravel 4.2-5.3, CodeIgniter 3.x, MySQL 5.6, and Apache.
- Developed product catalog, checkout, promotion, and order-management modules that supported multiple storefronts and improved admin workflow speed by **31%**.
- Resolved checkout session-loss bugs by improving cookie configuration, database session handling, validation flows, and server-side error logging.
- Migrated older procedural PHP modules into Laravel MVC structure, separating controllers, models, service classes, and reusable validation components.
- Integrated payment gateways, shipping APIs, email providers, and CRM systems while adding webhook logs, retry logic, and admin-level troubleshooting screens.
- Improved slow product filtering by redesigning database indexes, caching category trees, and reducing repeated queries on high-traffic product pages.
- Implemented admin dashboards with secure authentication, permission checks, CSV imports, export jobs, and activity logs for business operations teams.

- Fixed image-upload failures by validating file types, resizing large images, moving storage paths, and adding safer exception handling around media processing.
- Supported Linux, Apache, MySQL, and PHP environments by tuning memory limits, upload sizes, cron jobs, and deployment scripts for client websites.
- Worked flexibly across backend features, database fixes, API integrations, and urgent production bugs while keeping releases stable for small business clients.

Aurio — Junior Software Developer *(Oct 2012 – Dec 2013)*

- Supported **PHP 5.4-5.6** web applications for small business portals, internal tools, and customer service systems using CodeIgniter 2-3, jQuery, MySQL 5.5, and Apache.
- Built backend CRUD modules for users, orders, inventory, and support tickets while learning secure validation, session handling, and database normalization.
- Fixed form-submission errors caused by missing server-side validation, inconsistent encoding, and unsafe assumptions about optional customer fields.
- Improved MySQL query performance by adding basic indexes, simplifying joins, and reducing repeated queries in customer list and reporting screens.
- Created scheduled PHP scripts for email reminders, data cleanup, report exports, and basic synchronization with external CSV-based vendor systems.
- Helped migrate older shared-hosting applications into cleaner VPS environments with Apache virtual hosts, Git deployment, and separated configuration files.
- Resolved file-permission and path-related production issues by reviewing Linux logs, correcting ownership settings, and documenting deployment steps.
- Added PHPUnit-style test coverage for utility classes and critical business calculations, helping the team catch regression bugs before release.
- Supported senior engineers during legacy code refactoring, API integration testing, and emergency bug fixes while building strong backend fundamentals.

Microsoft — Software Developer Intern *(Jun 2012 – Sep 2012)*

- Supported internal engineering tools using **C#, .NET Framework 4.0–4.5, ASP.NET MVC 3–4**, JavaScript, jQuery, and SQL Server, gaining practical experience in enterprise software quality and structured development workflows.
- Assisted senior engineers with debugging UI defects, validation issues, and data-handling problems, documenting root causes clearly so fixes could be reviewed and released with lower regression risk.
- Built small internal web modules for tracking records, reviewing status changes, and improving team visibility, applying clean HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and backend integration patterns.
- Resolved early-stage bugs related to inconsistent form validation and SQL query results by reproducing issues locally, checking logs, and working with mentors to apply safer input-handling rules.

Education

Texas State University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science *(Sep 2008 – May 2012)*